Dr. Soma Mandal – Midlife Women's Health Expert

Talking Points & Helpful Questions

New Menopause Book & Why The Stigma?

1. Tell us about your new book "Dear Menopause, I Do Not Fear You", and what a reader can expect to learn by reading it?
2. You are passionate about menopause being an opportunity for women to reinvent themselves – to "uplevel themselves". Tell us more about this.
3. Why the mystique and stigma around menopause? Why do we know so much about puberty and pregnancy and child birth – but then when it comes to menopause, the knowledge base of the general population (including mid-life women) seems to fall away?
4. What are some of the biggest menopause myths and are they true? eg; menopause is experienced pretty much the same for all women, menopause means weight gain and a loss of identity.

What Is Menopause

5. Exactly what is menopause? What about peri-menopause?
6. How does a woman know she's in menopause?

Symptoms & Treatments

7. What's the best way to deal with hot flashes? Night sweats?
8. What are some of the special heart health considerations for women going through menopause?
9. Breast changes – what do women need to know? What about breast cancer considerations?
10. Skin changes? Hair changes? What do you recommend?
11. Sex and the menopause woman – in your book you dedicate a chapter to this topic and you tell readers that the best sex of their life is waiting!

12. Can you talk about the role of hormone replacement therapy (HRT) – is it good, is it bad? What do we need to know? What are the risks?
13. What about the role of natural therapies? Can you talk more about natural supplements and alternatives to HRT?

Menopause for Women Of Color

14. There's very little written in the US about cultural considerations and menopause, and how women of color have to take extra special care of their health during the transition, and the underlying reasons why?

Men-O-Pause & Men

15. Most men seem baffled/bewildered by menopause and could use the education about what to expect and how to best help their significant other through the transition. What's your advice?